`cord` objects with all their fields available to you. Other than the value, the most important fields are the offset and the key.

You have a first example of consuming from a Kafka topic. Now let's go a little further. Start with the following test:

1. Exit the application.
2. Push two more elements into the Kafka topic.
3. Restart the application.
4. Push another element into the Kafka topic.

The consumer only outputs this last element. The other two are missing because the `plainSource` does not keep the offset by default. It starts with the last element.

## Key Kafka concepts

To better understand the rest of the chapter, you should be familiar with the following Kafka concepts. As mentioned earlier, Alpakka consumers are built on top of the Apache Kafka API, specifically `KafkaConsumer`.

### Kafka consumers

A Kafka consumer takes care of the failures of Kafka brokers and the migration of topics between brokers. If a broker goes down while you're consuming from it, or the topic you're reading gets moved to another broker, it's not your problem. The consumer takes care of that for you. However, a TCP connection to the brokers is established; if you don't close the connection, it will remain open on the broker's side, causing a leak on the server.

### Offsets and consumer positions